UNGRADED PRACTICE

STAR(T) Practice: Adaptability & Leadership

A story about adjusting when things changed, or stepping up when it mattered.

Adaptability & Leadership is about adjusting when things change and stepping up to help others toward a goal. Leadership here doesn't need a title. It shows up when you take initiative, keep someone else going, or keep moving when circumstances shift.

This is practice, and it isn't graded. Draft your story here, then record it or copy it into the matching STAR(T) Stories portal in Blackboard.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Adaptability & Leadership Practice Guide in the STAR(T) Stories Guide. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Aim for a story that runs 2 to 4 minutes out loud.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

STEP 0

Find your story first

Your story can come from school, work, family, or your community. It doesn't have to be dramatic. It has to be real, and yours.

- Was there a time your plan fell apart and you had to change course, without falling apart yourself?
- Have you ever stepped up to lead, in a group, at work, or in your family, even though nobody officially asked you to?
- Is there a moment when you helped someone else stay motivated or on track when things got hard?
- Did you have to adjust to a new place, a new system, or new expectations, and figure it out?

The experience I'm going to use

S Situation

Set the scene. What was going on?

> Give just enough context for someone who wasn't there. Two or three sentences is usually plenty.

Watch out: The Situation is the setup, not the story. Get to the Task quickly.

T Task

Define your role. What was yours to do?

> For this skill, the Task is often something unexpected landing in your lap, or noticing that someone needed to step up and deciding that someone was you.

Watch out: Your Task is what you were responsible for, not the group's general goal.

A Action

Show what you did, step by step.

> This is the most important step. Use "I": I decided, I reached out, I chose. Show how you responded when things changed: the decisions you made, the steps you took, and how you supported others.

Watch out: "We figured it out" hides your part. Describe what you did, even inside a group effort.

R Result

Name the outcome. What happened because of what you did?

> Results for this skill often show up in how the group did, in relationships, or in your own growth, not just in getting the task done.

Watch out: "It went well" isn't a result. Name what specifically happened.

T Transfer

Connect it forward. What does this mean for what comes next?

> College, work, and life will keep asking you to adapt and step up. Where specifically do you expect to need this skill next, and what does this story tell you about how you'll handle it?

Watch out: "This will help me in the future" isn't a Transfer. Name a specific place, role, or situation.

AFTER YOU DRAFT IT

Quick reflection

Which step was hardest to write, and why do you think that is?

Does anything sound generic, like anyone could have written it? Where could you be more specific?